MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS

Approved 9/16/2026

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

~~Unapproved~~ minutes
August 19, 2026

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 3 Jacob Gross, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis, District 8 George Gilmore and District 9 Rick Fancon

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

District 1 Marlene Housler and District 2 Bob Keasey

OTHERS PRESENT

Clerk & Register of Deeds Lori Mott, Administrator Lori Phelps, Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger, Deputy Clerk Isha Walter, members of the public and zoom participants

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve the agenda, **motion carried.**

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the Board of Commissioners Minutes of July 15, 2026, the Board of Commissioners Special Meeting Minutes of July 7, 2026 and August 5, 2026, **motion carried**.

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

A member of the public requested information regarding the 2024 Prosecutor vs. Clare County lawsuit and made suggestions regarding the airport budget. Another member of the public commented regarding the airport.

Clare County Road Commission Manager Dewayne Rogers reported that he will give the Board of Commissioners a monthly update to improve communication between the Board and the Road Commission. He proceeded to introduce Brent Lynch, the sign shop foreman. Brent Lynch is the direct contact at the Road Commission for questions or concerns regarding signs, speed limit issues, speed studies, traffic concerns, etc. Lastly, Dewayne Rogers shared a detailed update regarding the work completed so far this year in the county and the purchase of the Warner building and surrounding twenty eight acres.

COMMUNICATIONS LIST

1. Medical Examiner Monthly Report

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT

Administrator Lori Phelps reported that the Heartland Materials Management Group completed the work on the Materials Management Plan. The completed plan will be brought before the Board during the September meeting. She encouraged the Commissioners to reach out to her with any questions on the proposed budget.

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT - continued

A Special Meeting was scheduled for September 2, 2026 to complete discussions and address any needed changes to the budget. The Fiscal Year 2027 budget public hearing and proposed adoption will take place on September 16, 2026 during the regular Board meeting. Administrator Phelps reported that the Employee Health Insurance open enrollment and the County's Annual Liability Insurance renewal are set for September. Lastly, the request for proposals for Clare County's contracted Information Technology services are posted on the website and due by August 26, 2026.

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS

1. Community Mental Health for Central Michigan
   Brian Krogman, Executive Director, and Sara Miceli-Sorenson, Chief Clinical Officer, presented the Board of Commissioners with an annual update. They highlighted key achievements and outcomes involving Clare County residents.

JUSTICE

1. Child Care Fund
   It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to appropriate $130,000.00 from the General Fund into the Child Care Fund, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (6) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell and Kleinhardt
   Nays: (1) being Commissioner Hoefling
   Absent: (2) being Commissioners Housler and Keasey
   Motion carried.

HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

None

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

1. Equalization
   It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Haskell to approve the L-4029 millage rates to be levied for the 2026 Winter Tax Bills, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Kleinhardt, Hoefling, Haskell, Gross, Gilmore, Fancon and Ambrozaitis
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (2) being Commissioners Housler and Keasey
   Motion carried.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Statutory Finance Committee
   It was moved by Commissioner Kleinhardt, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to approve Statutory Finance Committee meeting minutes of July 20, 2026 in the amount of $81,000.86 and the meeting minutes of August 3, 2026 in the amount of $95,302.64, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling and Kleinhardt
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (2) being Commissioners Housler and Keasey
   Motion carried.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION - continued

2. Monthly Expenditures
   It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the expenditures for the month of July 2026 in the amount of $2,809,010.77 with the General Fund expenditures totaling $1,495,587.08, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Kleinhardt, Hoefling, Haskell, Gross, Gilmore, Fancon and Ambrozaitis
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (2) being Commissioners Housler and Keasey
   Motion carried.

3. Budget Adjustments
   It was moved by Commissioner Gross, seconded by Commissioner Haskell to approve Budget Adjustment #26-123 in the amount of $72,669.05, #26-134 in the amount of $91,677.00, #26-143 in the amount of $309,766.00, #26-144 in the amount of $170,210.00 and #26-148 in the amount of $145,000.00, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling and Kleinhardt
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (2) being Commissioners Housler and Keasey
   Motion carried.

4. Land Bank
   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to appoint Kayla Randle to the Land Bank Board representing the Farwell Area with a term expiring September 30, 2027, **motion carried.**

TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger provided all the statutory finance reports to the Commissioners. She pointed out that the General Fund balance will begin to increase since the fourth quarter is when the largest amount of revenue comes in. All twenty six of the available properties sold during the County's recent public land sale. Lastly, Treasurer Beemer-Fritzinger reported that the Land Bank demolition projects are complete and the rehabilitation project in Lincoln Township is almost complete.

CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Chairman George Gilmore has attended his meetings and had nothing to report.

VICE CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Vice Chairman Rick Fancon had no report.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT

Commissioner Ambrozaitis gave an update on recent meetings he has attended.

Commissioner Hoefling gave a report on the townships and committees he represents.

Commissioner Kleinhardt gave a brief update on a recently attended Michigan Counties Association meeting in Roscommon.

Commissioner Haskell stated that the Central Michigan Health Department's New Officer took over this month and that the Harrison Street Fair will be this weekend.

Commissioner Gross mentioned his plan to attend the Mid State Substance Use Policy Board meeting in Lansing.

PUBLIC COMMENT

A Clare County resident confirmed he is a taxpayer and listed his concerns with transparency and compliance.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Gross to have a meeting on September 2, 2026 at 9:00 a.m., **motion carried**.

NEW BUSINESS

None

ADJOURNMENT

Meeting adjourned at 9:47 a.m.

Lori Mott, Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

George Gilmore, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners